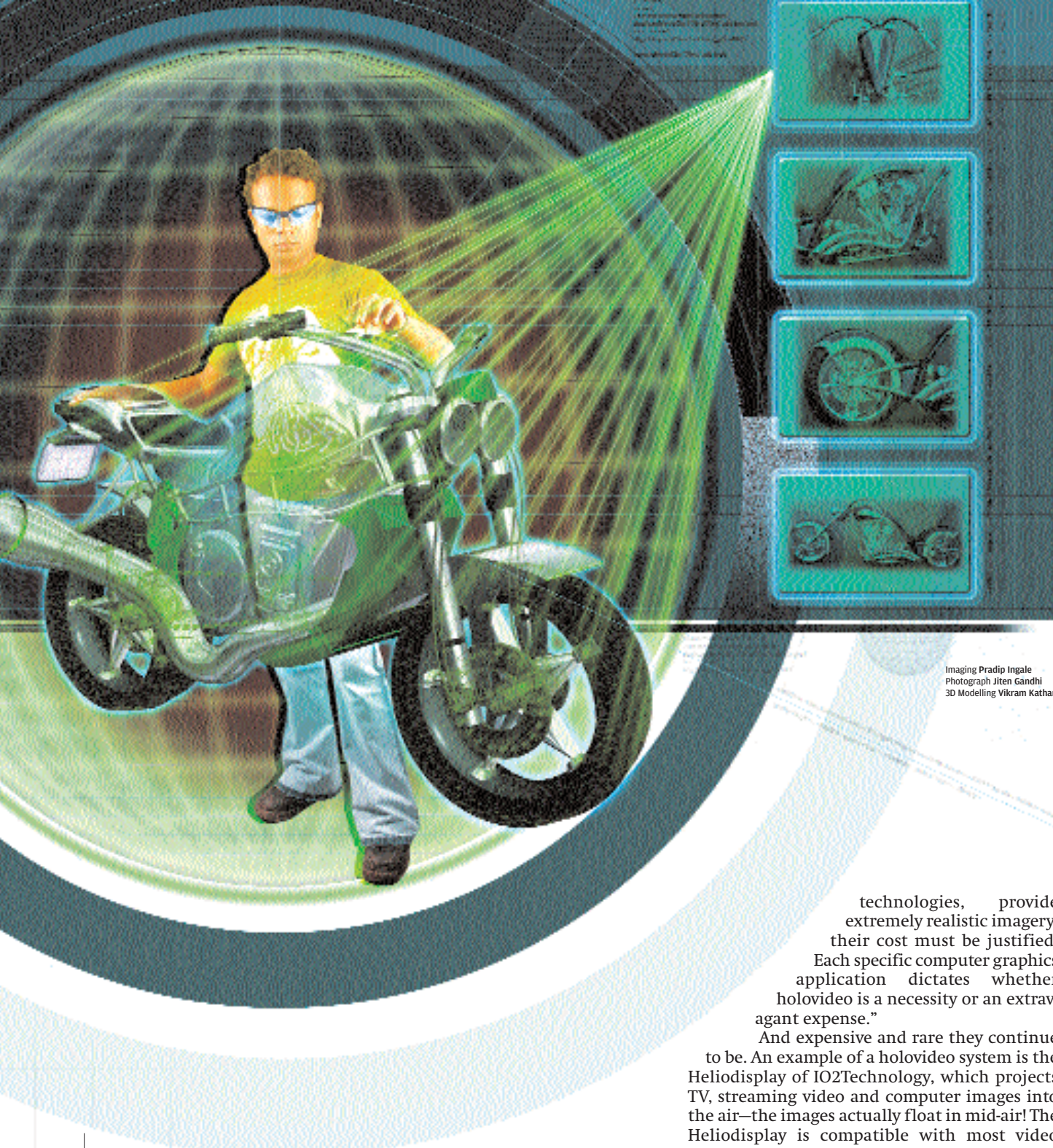




Imaging Pradip Ingale
Photograph Jiten Gandhi
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There are several such systems in existence, and each claims to be better than the other. We've all experienced such 3D in IMAX theatres; there's nothing new about such products. Personal 3D has, however, seen improved realism in the past decade. But who wants to wear comical-looking glasses?

Holographic Displays: The Heliodisplay

Mark Lucente of IBM's Thomas J Watson Research Center wrote in 1997, "Real-time 3D holographic displays are expensive, new, and rare. Although they alone, among 3D display

technologies, provide extremely realistic imagery, their cost must be justified. Each specific computer graphics application dictates whether holovideo is a necessity or an extravagant expense."

And expensive and rare they continue to be. An example of a holovideo system is the Heliodisplay of IO2Technology, which projects TV, streaming video and computer images into the air—the images actually float in mid-air! The Heliodisplay is compatible with most video sources, and, in fact, is interactive: it's a floating touch-screen. Remember the movie *Minority Report*?

A post on a popular geeks' forum said, "News of a 3D display that projects an interactive image into thin air, the Heliodisplay, is not exactly fresh. What is new however, is that this once far-fetched conceptual object is now real, working and being sold. The Heliodisplay projects into the air—without the need for a special screen—images fed to it from a variety of sources. In a way, it's a working version of R2D2's holographic projection system."

So how does it work? Well, the display is a box no bigger than your PC cabinet lying on its